



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "does free will explain all evil?" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

does free
will explain
all evil?

Suppose that this is true. What premise in the above argument would this objection target?

Let's consider two replies to this objection.

1. The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami is an evil.
2. There is no good which outweighs this event and which is such that an omnipotent being could not have brought about the good without the evil.
3. A perfectly good being would eliminate every evil unless there was a good which outweighed that evil and it was impossible for that being to eliminate the evil without eliminating the good.
4. There is no omnipotent and perfectly good being.
(1,2,3)
5. If there is no omnipotent and perfectly good being, God does not exist.

C. God does not exist. (4,5)

THE ARGUMENT FROM NATURAL EVIL

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**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can explain some evil; but it can't explain all of the evil we find in the world.

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God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

Summing up so far: we have seen that Frege will promise to explain how

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good

the ability
to harm others
is a great good



does not exist.

eliminating the good.

there was a good weight and it was

The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami is avail.

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5 If there is no merit and perfectly good being, God

c. God does not exist. (4,5)

3. Absolutely good being would eliminate every evil



2 There is no good which outweighs this event and which is

impossible for that being to eliminate the evil without

such that an infant being fed not have brought

4. There is no moment and perfectly good being. (1, 2, 3)

The argument from natural evil

Let's consider two replies to this objection.